

CALIMESA FIRE DEPARTMENT
POLICY MANUAL
VOLUME 2 -EMPLOYEE MANUAL
Policy: 202.02 Code of Ethics

11/2023

PURPOSE

This purpose of this policy is to foster mutual respect and trust between the members of the Calimesa Fire Department and the citizens of the City of Calimesa, and to maintain the integrity of the fire service, by always maintaining the highest standards of ethical conduct.

POLICY

All Department members are required to follow this Code of Ethics and the Code of Ethics set forth in the City of Calimesa Personnel Rules and Regulations Rule 3.

The Fire Chief and all other members of the Fire Department, in accord with the highest standards of ethical conduct will:

1. Accept a personal obligation to the citizens of Calimesa to serve them with honesty and competent professional effort.
2. Act impartially and vigorously to advance the dignity of the Fire Chief and the community of Calimesa.
3. Share personal knowledge, skills, and experience with others for the improvement of the environment and welfare of the citizens within Calimesa.
4. Support the human rights of all and discourage any form of discrimination because of sex, race, creed, age, political affiliation or origin, or any form of sexual harassment or any other type of harassment based on a protected status.
5. Maintain high standards of excellence in professional performance, personal conduct and good citizenship.
6. Obey the laws of the City of Calimesa, the County of Riverside, the State of California, and the U.S. Federal Government.
7. Be honest and realistic in reporting all statements, schedules, costs and performance.
8. Support this code of ethics and encourage colleagues and co-workers to act in accordance with this code.
9. Every officer and member shall:
 - a. Be held responsible for the safekeeping, care and reasonable use of all Department property under their control.
 - b. Use of equipment and time for Department.
 - c. Promptly notify their supervisor of all matters coming to the attention of the employee which affects the interest and welfare of the Department.
 - d. At all times be courteous and respectful to the public and co-workers.
 - e. Immediately report to their supervisor any accident, sickness, or injury to themselves, no matter how minor.
 - f. In matters of general conduct, be governed by the ordinary rules of good behavior observed by law-abiding and self-respecting citizens and commit no act tending to

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bring reproach or reflection upon the Department, or the City, whether in uniform or not.

- g. In the interest of economy, conserve water, gas, fuel, oil, electricity supplies, etc., in quarters.
- h. Adhere to all Department policies and procedures.
- i. Practice safety at all times.
- j. Outside employment authorization must come from the Fire Chief and City Manager to determine potential incompatibility of employment and shall comply with Policy 102.04. This provision shall only apply to full-time personnel. Part-time personnel may engage in outside employment without the prior written approval of the City but shall comply with all prohibitions or restrictions on outside employment as set forth in Policy 102.04 and Rule 8 of Section 1 of the City's Personnel Rules and Regulations, as amended from time to time.

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Policy: 202.03 Professionalism and Public Behavior

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PURPOSE

The purpose of the Professionalism and Behavior Policy is to establish a basis for behavior in the public view.

STANDARD

The City of Calimesa Fire Department is a full-time, paid fire department and, as such, there is a distinct public expectation of professional appearance and behavior.

APPEARANCE

Uniforms shall be kept in a condition which represents a respectable level of professionalism.

Uniforms that are tattered, faded, or have t-shirt lettering showing an exceptional amount of cracking or stripping shall be replaced.

Station service boots or safety boots shall have a shine.

BEHAVIOR

The Calimesa Fire Department cannot legislate attitude; however, attitude is usually displayed through an individual's behavior. Guidelines for acceptable behavior while on-duty is as follows:

1. While in the public, personnel will refrain from offensive or disrespectful language or behavior that can be seen or heard by members of the public.
2. Disrespectful or offensive language or behavior within the station will not be tolerated.
3. Disrespectful or offensive language or behavior on any City property will not be tolerated.

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Policy: 202.04 Flag Etiquette

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PURPOSE

The purpose of the Flag Etiquette Policy is to display and establish respect for the Flag of the United States.

1. “The Flag of the United States should be flown daily from sunrise and sunset in Calimesa. It will be placed at 0800 to 1700 in good weather from public buildings, schools (on school days, permanent staffs in the open, and in or near polling places on election days.
2. The Flag may be displayed 24 hours a day on special patriotic occasions or for a patriotic effect, if properly illuminated during the hours of darkness.
3. The Flag should not be displayed on days when the weather is bad, except when an all-weather flag is used.
4. The Flag should always be flown on Federal and State holidays and on those occasions proclaimed by the President.
5. On Memorial Day the Flag should be flown at half-staffed until noon.
6. The Flag should be hoisted briskly and lowered ceremoniously.
7. It should never be dipped to any person or thing, nor should it ever be displayed with the union down except as a signal of dire distress.
8. The Flag should never touch anything beneath it, nor should it ever be carried flat or horizontally - always aloft and free.
9. It should never be used as wearing apparel, bedding, drapery or decoration for carrying or holding anything, or stored in such a manner that it will be damaged or soiled.
10. The Flag should never be fastened, displayed, used or stored in such a manner as to be easily torn, soiled or damaged.
11. It should never be used as a covering for a ceiling.
12. The Flag should not be draped over the hood, top, and side or back of a vehicle or of a railroad train or a boat.

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13. When a Flag is displayed on a car, the Flag's staff should be fixed firmly to the chassis or clamped to the right fender.
14. The Flag or its staff should never be used for advertising purposed in any manner whatsoever, nor should any picture, drawing, insignia or other decoration be placed upon or attached to the Flag, its staff or halyard.
15. The Flag should not be embroidered on cushions, handkerchiefs or other personal items nor printed on anything designed for temporary use and then discarded.
16. A Flag patch may be affixed to the uniform of military, fire and police personnel and members of patriotic organizations.
17. When the Flag is so worn or soiled that it is no longer suitable for display, it should be destroyed in a dignified manner, preferably by burning.
18. NO DISRESPECT OF ANY KIND SHOULD BE SHOWN TO THE FLAG OF THE UNITED STATES.

RULES FOR LOWERING THE FLAG TO HALF STAFF

1. The Flag is half-staffed on Memorial Day, May 30th, from 0800 to 1200. Then at full staffed from 1200 till 1700.
2. Since the Flag symbolizes the Nation, it should be half-staffed only in cases where it is appropriate to indicate that the Nation mourns and then customarily by proclamation of the President of the United States.
3. When it is desired to show that a state, city, club, large industry, or a society mourns, then the state, city club, industry, or society flag or banner should be half-staffed or dressed in crepe.
4. The Flag should be half-staffed in case of the death of the President of the United States or of an ex-President during a thirty-day period of national mourning from 0800 to 1700.
5. The proclamation of the President announcing the death of a national figure other than the President or ex-President also directs the time of mourning.
6. The Flag should not be half-staffed on Veteran's Day, November 11th

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7. The Flag should not be displayed on days when the weather is inclement. (This has also been interpreted to include extremely windy weather when damage to the Flag is possible).

HOW TO DISPLAY THE FLAG

1. When the Flag is displayed in a manner other than by being flown from a staff, it should be displayed flat whether indoors or outdoors.
2. When the Flags of two or more nations are displayed, they should be flown from separate staffs of the same height, and the Flags should be of approximately the same size.
3. International usage forbids the display of the Flag of one nation above that of another in time of peace.
4. The Flag should never be displayed with union (blue field) down except as a signal of dire distress.
5. The Flag should not be dipped to any person or thing, except that naval vessels, upon receiving a salute of this type from a vessel registered by a nation formally recognized by the United States, must return the compliment.
6. When the Flag is displayed flat, either horizontally or vertically on a wall or in a window, the union (blue field) should be uppermost and to the Flag's own right (to the observer's left when facing the Flag).
7. When the Flag is displayed from a staff projecting from a windowsill, balcony, or front of a building, the union should be at the staff's peak, unless the Flag is to be displayed at half-staff.
8. When the Flag is displayed over the middle of a street, it should be suspended vertically with the union to the north in an East-West Street, or to the east in a North-South Street.
9. When suspended over a sidewalk from a rope extending from a building to a pole at the edge of the sidewalk, the Flag should be hoisted from the building union first.
10. When displayed with another Flag from crossed staffs, the National Flag should be on its own right, with its staff in front of the staff of the other Flag.
11. When the National Flag and other Flags are grouped and displayed from staffs, the National Flag should be at the center and at the highest point of the group or they may be

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aligned so that all staffs are at the same height with the Flag of the United States on its own right and all other Flags to its left (the National Flag should be to the viewer's left).

12. The National Flag should always be to the peak when other Flags or pennants are flown on the same halyard.
13. When it is to be flown at half-staff, the Flag is first raised to the peak and then lowered to the half-staff position.
14. When being lowered for the day, it should be raised to the peak, and then lowered.

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Policy: 202.05 Employee Identification Card

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PURPOSE

The purpose of the Employee Identification Card Policy is to establish a structure in which staff must have in possession an authorized department identification card while on duty.

POLICY

The Calimesa Fire Department shall issue to every member a department approved identification card that contains a photo of the employee in a class B uniform.

Calimesa Fire Department employees are authorized to use the identification card as a form of personal identification.

Fire Department members shall not use their department identification card to solicit gratuities or gifts of any kind and shall not use their Department identification card to solicit otherwise lawful discounts, rewards, loans, or fees without first obtaining Department approval.

Fire Department members shall not utilize their department identification card in a manner that would discredit or demean the Calimesa Fire Department or the City of Calimesa.

The identification card remains the property of the Calimesa Fire Department. As such, when a Fire Department employee separates from the fire department the identification card must be returned to the department.

Upon personnel being promoted, a new identification card must be generated to reflect the employee's new classification. .